

Nikita Kiselev

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Senior ML Research Engineer

WORK EXPERIENCE

Kandinsky Lab, Sber

Senior Research Engineer Aug 2026 – Present

- **Kandinsky 6.0 (text-to-audio-video, image-to-audio-video):** Post-Training: SFT. Alignment: RLHF.

Research Engineer Jan 2025 – Jul 2026

- **Kandinsky 5.0 (text-to-image, image-to-image):** Post-Training: SFT, Instruct SFT. Alignment: RLHF (DPO, DRAFT, GRPO, DGPO). Applications: Text Rendering, Interior Design, Stylization.
- **Kandinsky 4.1 (text-to-image, text-to-video, image-to-video):** Performed text-to-image SFT via innovative LoRA-Soup technique. Text-to-video LoRA fine-tuning for 70+ characters from Russian culture code, distilled them into one model. Developed and trained a new image-to-video model maintaining structural dynamics.

Research Intern Jun 2024 – Dec 2024

- **Kandinsky 3 (image-to-image):** Interior Design with Kandinsky 3 ControlNet for Domclick. Kandinsky 3 ControlNet Style (DepthPro) that outperforms ControlNet Union SDXL by 100% on ImageReward.

Research Center for Artificial Intelligence, Innopolis University

Mathematician-programmer Sep 2024 – Jul 2025

Laboratory of Mathematical Methods of Optimization, MIPT

Technician Oct 2023 – Apr 2024

FEATURED PUBLICATIONS (17 IN TOTAL)

1. Kandinsky Lab, Sber. Kandinsky 6.0 Video: Foundation Models for Synchronized Video and Audio Generation.
2. Kandinsky Lab, Sber. Kandinsky 5.0: A Family of Foundation Models for Image and Video Generation. // **Top-1** Daily & Weekly & **Monthly Paper** on Hugging Face (November 2025)
3. D. Yarmoshik, A. Rogozin, N. Kiselev, D. Dorin, A. Gasnikov, D. Kovalev. Decentralized Optimization with Coupled Constraints. // **ICLR 2025, A***

FEATURED TALKS (12 IN TOTAL)

- September 28, 2026. Subspace of Maximum Curvature for Loss Landscape Stabilization // 16th International Conference on Intellectual Data Processing
- September 25, 2025. Sufficient sample size and its connection to the loss landscape convergence // 22nd All-Russian Conference on Mathematical Methods for Pattern Recognition

FEATURED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Russian Presidential Scholarship:
 - 2025 – 2027
- K.V. Rudakov scientific academic scholarship for research activities in the field of applied mathematics:
 - 2023 – 2026
- Personal scholarship for contributions to the development of numerical optimization methods:
 - 2023 – 2025

SUMMARY

Senior ML Research Engineer at Kandinsky Lab. Develops SFT and RLHF for Kandinsky 6.0 text-to-audio-video and image-to-audio-video. Previously built post-training and alignment for Kandinsky 5.0 and 4.1 image and video models. Strong mathematical background in optimization and loss-landscape geometry. Lecturer in deep learning and generative models.

SKILLS

DL: PyTorch, Huggingface, Accelerate, Multi GPU training: DDP/FSDP/SP/TP, W&B, TensorBoard
ML: NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, NetworkX, Scikit-learn, LightGBM, CatBoost
OS: macOS, Linux, Windows
Misc.: Git, Bash, $\LaTeX$
Soft: responsible, organized, critical thinker, flexible, communicative, team player, patient

EDUCATION

MIPT **Moscow, Russia**
PhD in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning
Sep 2026 – Present

Thesis: Scaling of Parametric Machine Learning Models Based on the Local Geometry of the Optimization Surface. Advisor: Andrey Grabovoy, PhD.

MIPT **Moscow, Russia**
MSc in Computer Science
Sep 2024 – Aug 2026

Thesis: Sample Size Determination for Parametric Models. Advisor: Andrey Grabovoy, PhD. GPA: 5/5.

MIPT **Moscow, Russia**
BSc in Applied Mathematics and Physics
Sep 2020 – Aug 2024

Thesis: Bayesian Sample Size Estimation. Advisor: Andrey Grabovoy, PhD. GPA: 4.88/5 (with honours).

LANGUAGES

- Russian (Native)
- English (Advanced)

INTERESTS

- Coffee, Wine, Jazz, Classic Guitar
- Gym, Hiking, Traveling